

David Orvek

Curriculum Vitae

EDUCATION

Indiana University, Bloomington, IN

Ph.D. in Music Theory

Anticipated December 2025

Minors in Music History and Guitar Performance

Dissertation (working title): “Listening to the Music of Brian Ferneyhough”

Advisor: Andrew Mead

The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH

M.A. in Music Theory

2019

Thesis: [“Generalized Transformational Voice-Leading Systems”](#)

Advisor: David Clampitt

Southern Adventist University, Collegedale, TNB.S. in Music Theory and Literature, *summa cum laude*

2016

Honors thesis: [“Ex Nihilo: An Inquiry into the Nature of Musical Composition”](#)

Advisors: J. Bruce Ashton and Daniel Maxwell

TEACHING POSITIONS

Butler University, Indianapolis, IN

Lecturer in Music Theory

Fall 2024–present

Instructor of Music Theory (full time)

Spring 2023–Spring 2024

Adjunct Instructor of Music Theory

Fall 2022

Indiana University, Bloomington, IN

Graduate Associate Instructor

Fall 2019–Summer 2023

The Ohio State University, Columbus, OH

Graduate Teaching Associate

Fall 2017–Spring 2019

Southern Adventist University, Collegedale, TN

Teacher’s Assistant

Fall 2014–Fall 2016

COURSES TAUGHT

Butler University

Aural Skills Fundamentals

Fall 2025

Special section of Aural Skills I for students who need more help

Aural Skills I

Fall 2025

Core aural skills course for undergraduate music majors	
Analysis of Music since 1900 Master's-level seminar	Spring 2025
Analysis of Tonal Music Master's-level seminar	Spring 2024
Graduate Music Theory Review Remedial course for graduate music students	Fall 2023
Form and Analysis Upper-level undergraduate course on form	Fall 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
Counterpoint Upper-level undergraduate introduction to modal and tonal counterpoint	Spring 2023, 2025
Music Theory 4 Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors	Spring 2022, 2024, 2025
Music Theory 3 Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors	Fall 2023, 2024
Music Theory 2 Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors	Spring 2023, 2024
Aural Skills 3 Core aural skills course for undergraduate music majors	Fall 2022, 2024, 2025
Indiana University	
<i>Instructor of Record</i>	
Written Theory Review for Graduate Students Remedial course for graduate music students	Summer 2023
Musical Skills IV Core aural skills course for undergraduate music majors	Summer 2022
Musical Skills II Core aural skills course for undergraduate music majors	Fall 2021, Spring 2022
<i>Under Faculty Supervision</i>	
Music Theory and Literature IV Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors	Spring 2021
Music Theory and Literature III Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors	Fall 2020

Music Theory and Literature II Spring 2020
Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory and Literature I Fall 2019
Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

The Ohio State University (under faculty supervision)

Aural Training II Spring 2018, 2019
Core aural skills course for undergraduate music majors

Aural Training I Fall 2017, 2018
Core aural skills course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory II Spring 2018, 2019
Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory I Fall 2017, 2018
Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Southern Adventist University (under faculty supervision)

Instructor

Basic Musicianship Fall 2014
Remedial theory course for undergraduate music majors

Teacher's Assistant

Music Theory III Fall 2015, 2016
Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory IV Spring 2016
Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory II Spring 2015
Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory I Fall 2014
Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

REFEREED PUBLICATIONS

Orvek, David E. [“Ungrading in the Music Theory Classroom: A One-Year Case Study.”](#) *Journal of Music Theory Pedagogy* 38 (2024): 45–69.

Orvek, David, and David Clappitt. [“SUM Classes and Quotient Generalized Interval Systems.”](#) In *Mathematics and Computation in Music: 8th International Conference, MCM 2022, Atlanta, GA, USA, June 21–24, 2022*, edited by Mariana Montiel, Octavio A. Agustín-Aquino, Francisco

Gómez, Jeremy Kastine, Emilio Lluís-Puebla, and Brent Milam, 99–111. Cham: Springer, 2022.

INVITED TALKS

“‘Like a Piece of Woven Material’: Unity and Organicism in Elizabeth Maconchy’s String Quartet No. 11”

Hartt School Music Theory Colloquium — University of Hartford 2022

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND POSTERS

“Experiencing the Music of Brian Ferneyhough”

Society for Music Theory — Minneapolis, MN 2025

“Ungrading in the Music Theory Classroom: A One-Year Case Study”

Pedagogy into Practice — University of Oklahoma 2024

“Ungrading, Trust, and Artificial Intelligence”

Society for Music Theory, Music Theory Pedagogy Interest Group — Denver, CO 2023

“Germaine Tailleferre’s Experiment with Serial Composition”

Patterns and Singularities: Graduate Students’ Conference — Indiana University 2023

“SUM Classes and Quotient Generalized Interval Systems”

Mathematics and Computation in Music — Atlanta, GA (with David Clampitt) 2022

“‘Like a Piece of Woven Material’: Unity and Organicism in Elizabeth Maconchy’s String Quartet No. 11”

Society for Music Theory — Online 2021

“Schubert, Schoenberg, and Some Extensions to Cohn’s Sum-Class System”

Society for Music Theory — Online (poster) 2020

South-Central Society for Music Theory — Nashville, TN 2020

“Closural Features in Non-Tonal Music: A Corpus Study of the Music of Schoenberg, Webern, and Berg”

Indiana University Symposium of Research in Music — Indiana University 2019

“Ex Nihilo: An Inquiry into the Nature of Musical Composition”

Southern Adventist University Campus Research Day — Southern Adventist University 2016

AWARDS

Commendation for exemplary performance in the PhD oral exam — Indiana University 2022

<u>Wennerstrom Music Theory Associate Instructor Fellowship</u> — Indiana University	2022
Annual departmental award for outstanding achievement as an Associate Instructor	
Graduate Associate Award — The Ohio State University	2019
Annual departmental award for outstanding achievement as a Graduate Associate	
Top Achiever Award for Academic Excellence — Southern Adventist University	2016

RELATED WORK EXPERIENCE

Editorial Assistant — Music Theory Spectrum	2024–present
Curriculum Designer — Music Fundamentals Online	2021
Office Assistant — School of Music, Southern Adventist University	2015–2016
Choral Librarian — School of Music, Southern Adventist University	2014–2016

ADVISING

Butler University

Advisor

Christian Miller, Butler Summer Institute project Summer 2025

Cameron Storey, Music Theory Emphasis paper Spring 2024

Committee Member

Charissa Garrigus, MA Musicology thesis Spring 2025

INSTITUTIONAL SERVICE

Butler University

Program for Undergraduate Research Committee Fall 2024–present

SERVICE TO THE FIELD

Program Committee — IU Symposium of Research in Music 2022 & 2023

Organizer and Panel Member — Southern Scholars Experiencing Grad School Q & A 2021
Q & A session for undergraduates interested in graduate school

Music Theory Midwest Technology Committee	2020–2023 (chair 2021–2023)
Co-Editor — Indiana Theory Review, vols. 37 & 38	2020–2023
Treasurer — Graduate Theory Association, Indiana University	2020–2021

RELATED SKILLS

Programming

Python, Music21, Humdrum, Bash, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP

Languages

German (novice), French (novice)